Napoleone eventually enlisted in the French army, but when the Revolution broke out in 1789, he went back to Corsica, hoping the revolution would provide an opportunity for his beloved island to achieve greater autonomy. Only after he fell out with the leader of the Corsican independence movement – Pasquale Paoli – did Napoleone abandon the Corsican cause in May 1793. He returned to the mainland, where he decided to build his future.[32] It was at this stage that Napoleone di Buonaparte turned into Napoleon Bonaparte (he continued to use the Italian version of his name until 1796).[33]

Why then was it rational for Napoleon to devote his military career to making France the dominant power in Europe? Was it perhaps more rational for him to stay in Corsica, patch up his personal disagreements with Paoli and devote himself to liberating his native island from its French conquerors? And maybe Napoleon should in fact have made it his life's mission to unite Italy – the land of his ancestors?

Clausewitz offers no method to answer these questions rationally. If our only rule of thumb is that 'every action must be aligned with some higher goal', by definition there is no rational way to define that ultimate goal. How then can we provide a computer network with an ultimate goal it must never ignore or subvert? Tech executives and engineers who rush to develop AI are making a huge mistake if they think there is a rational way to tell AI what its ultimate goal should be. They should learn from the bitter experiences of generations of philosophers who tried to define ultimate goals and failed.

THE KANTIAN NAZI

For millennia, philosophers have been looking for a definition of an ultimate goal that will not depend on an alignment to some higher goal. They have repeatedly been drawn to two potential solutions, known in philosophical jargon as deontology and utilitarianism. Deontologists (from the Greek word *deon*, meaning 'duty') believe that there are some universal moral duties, or moral rules, that apply to everyone. These rules do not rely on alignment to a higher goal, but rather on their intrinsic goodness. If such rules indeed exist, and if we can find a way to program them into